
Punaura Dham, Sitamarhi

Punaura Dham: The Epicenter of Devotion

Punaura Dham, situated approximately 2 kilometers from Sitamarhi town, holds immense religious importance as the birthplace of Goddess Sita. To transform this sacred site into a major pilgrimage destination, the Bihar government has sanctioned a redevelopment project. This project involves the acquisition of 50.50 acres of land to expand the existing temple complex, which currently spans 17 acres. The development plan includes modern amenities, improved accessibility, and enhanced facilities for pilgrims and tourists.

> ***Our aim is to develop Punaura Dham on the lines of Ayodhya's Ram Janmabhoomi, making it a focal point for spiritual tourism and cultural heritage.***
>
> **- Shri Raju Kumar Singh**
> Hon'ble Tourism Minister, Bihar

Strategic Development of Key Sites

Beyond Punaura Dham, the Bihar government has identified and initiated development projects at several other sites associated with the Ramayan:

- **Sitakund, East Champaran:**
A Substantial budget has been allocated for beautification, including the construction of an entrance gate, boundary wall, sanitation facilities, shops, and a cafeteria.


Haleshwar Sthan, Sitamarhi

- **Panthpakar, Sitamarhi:**
Plans for temple expansion, ghat restoration, new access paths, thematic entry gates, lighting, and parking facilities, with a 24-month project timeline.

- **Girijasthan Temple, Phulhar, Madhubani:**
Development into a tourist destination with modern amenities such as laser fountains, toilet blocks, ghat development, and dedicated parking.

- **Ahilya Sthan, Darbhanga:**
A Significant budget allocated for rejuvenation, including a boundary wall, meditation pond, guesthouse, cafeteria, and pavilions.

These projects aim to enhance the spiritual and cultural experience for visitors while preserving the sanctity and historical significance of each site.


Panth Pakar, Sitamarhi

Policy Reforms and Investment Incentives

To support the development of the Ramayan Circuit and other tourism initiatives, the Bihar government has introduced several policy reforms:

- **Bihar Tourism Policy 2023:**
Revised to attract investments in the hotel and hospitality sector, with provisions such as SGST reimbursement extended up to seven years for new establishments.

- **Investment Threshold Adjustments:**
Minimum investment requirements for star-category hotels have been reduced, encouraging smaller investors to participate in the tourism sector .


Girijasthan Temple, Phulhar, Madhubani

Integration with National Tourism Initiatives

The development of the Ramayan Circuit in Bihar aligns with national tourism initiatives such as the Swadesh Darshan Scheme and the PRASHAD Scheme. These programs aim to develop theme-based tourist circuits and pilgrimage sites across India, enhancing infrastructure and promoting cultural heritage.

Under the Swadesh Darshan Scheme, Sitamarhi, Buxar, and Darbhanga have been identified for development as part of the Ramayan Circuit . Additionally, Punaura Dham has been included under the PRASHAD Scheme, focusing on the development of pilgrimage sites .

> ***We envision Sitamarhi as a world-class tourism destination, equipped with world class infrastructure. Our goal is to establish it as one of the most important destinations of the larger Ramayan Circuit—not just in Bihar, but across the entire country***
>
> **- Shri Lokesh Kumar Singh**
> Secretary,
> Department of Tourism, Bihar


Ahilya Sthan, Darbhanga